CURRENT / PDF 7

C H A P T E R 1

Getting Started

This chapter will help you unpack your Macintosh PiForma, set up its traveling companions, and start the computer. You will also learn how to check a reluctant battery, shut down properly, and return everything to the bag. The packing order is worth a little attention. The foam has opinions.

Unpacking the equipment

Set the carrying bag upright on a stable surface and open it. Leave room nearby for each item as you take it out.

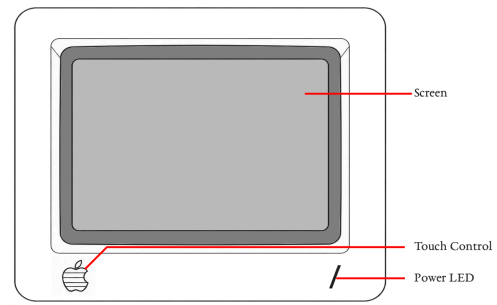
1. Remove the small brown accessory pouch near the top. It contains two Nintendo 64 controllers, the USB hub, and the power cable. Set the pouch and its contents aside.
2. Take out the mouse and the collapsible computer stand beneath the pouch.
3. Remove this printed guide.
4. Lift out the mouse pad beneath the guide.
5. Remove the velvet-covered foam board beneath the mouse pad. Keep it flat; it protects the computer when everything is packed.

PROPOSED / study 1

CHAPTER 1

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Set the carrying bag upright on a stable surface and open it. Leave room nearby for each item as you take it out.

The power switch does not disconnect external charging power from the internal charger. Switching the computer off alone does not make internal electrical work safe. Do not disassemble it with charging power connected. Internal repairs and battery disconnection belong with someone familiar with this particular build, not in a first-start procedure.

Stop using the computer if it becomes unusually hot, smells hot, or has damaged power wiring or a damaged battery. Do not keep retrying power-on in that condition. Use the intended charging equipment. This privately built device has no claimed electrical-safety certification.

Starting up the computer

1. Find the physical power control on the right side and switch the PiForma on.
2. Look for the green light at the front.
3. Listen for a startup chime. Depending on the rear selector's position, there may be no sound.
4. Watch for the startup picture or sequence. The desktop normally follows in about one to two minutes; allow for some variation.

A silent startup does not by itself mean that the computer has failed. Use the green light and display as well as the chime when checking what has happened.

Checking the battery

If nothing happens, check the battery before assuming something has broken. The outside plunger mechanically presses the button on the internal battery pack, showing its charge indicators; the owner reports that pressing it may also wake or enable the pack.

The normal, management-approved way to read the battery is to press the rear battery plunger to turn on its display, then peer through the slits in the top to see the percentage. You do not have to open the compartment for this check.

The startup chime

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The PiForma is underneath the board, with its monitor/screen facing upward. The keyboard is tucked against one side of the computer. It is not another layer in the stack. Watch that it does not catch as you remove the PiForma.

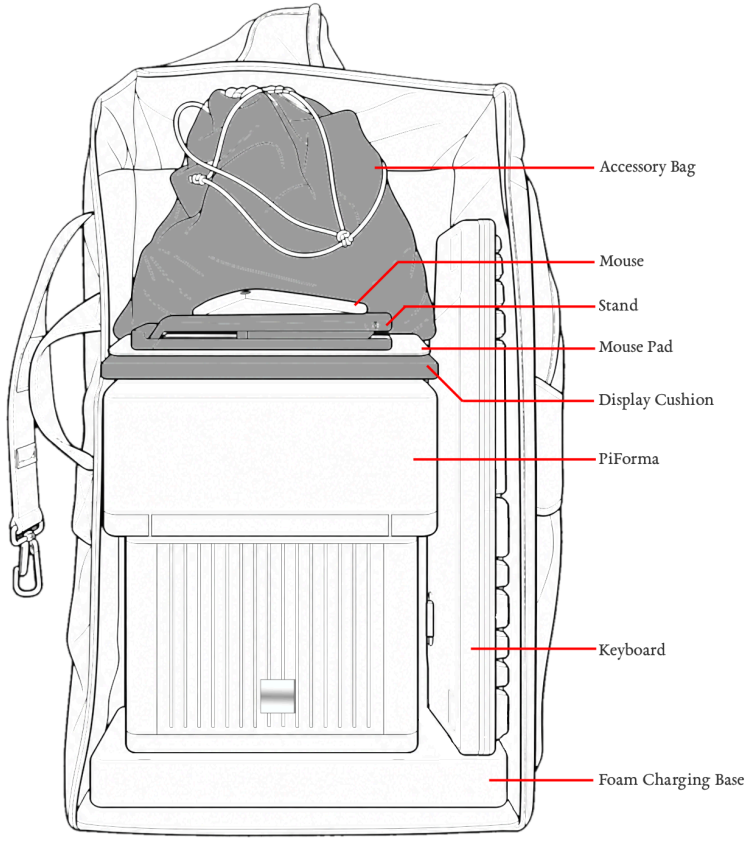


Figure 1-1. Arrangement in the carrying bag. The printed guide is not shown; it lies beneath the mouse and stand, above the mouse pad.

Unpacking the equipment

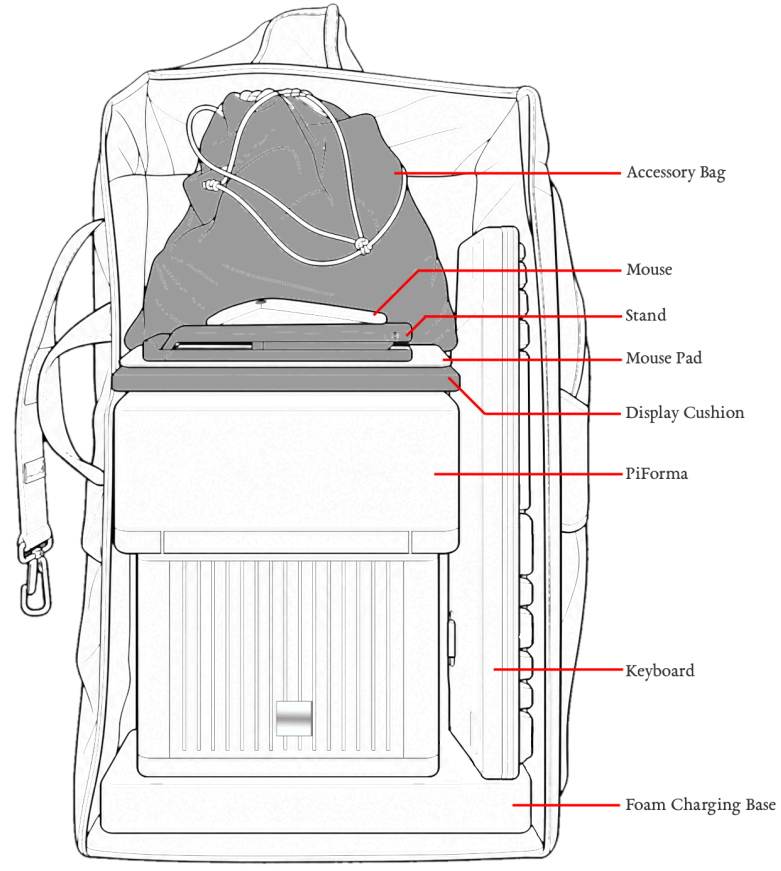


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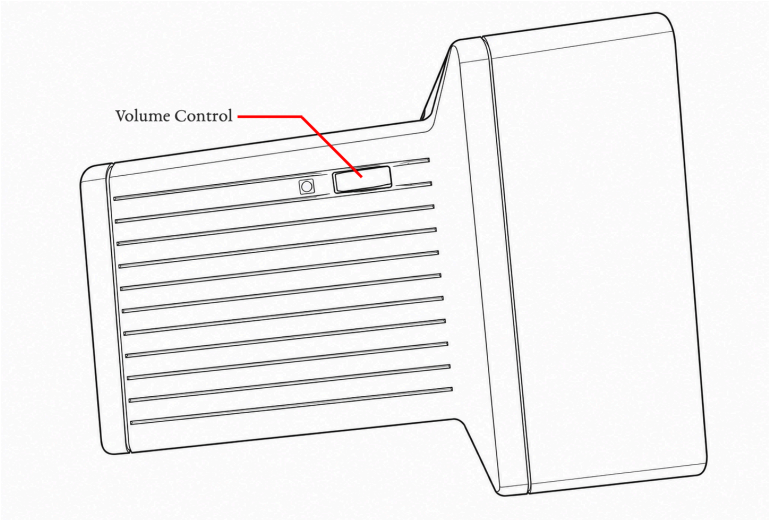


Figure 1-3d. The side volume control.

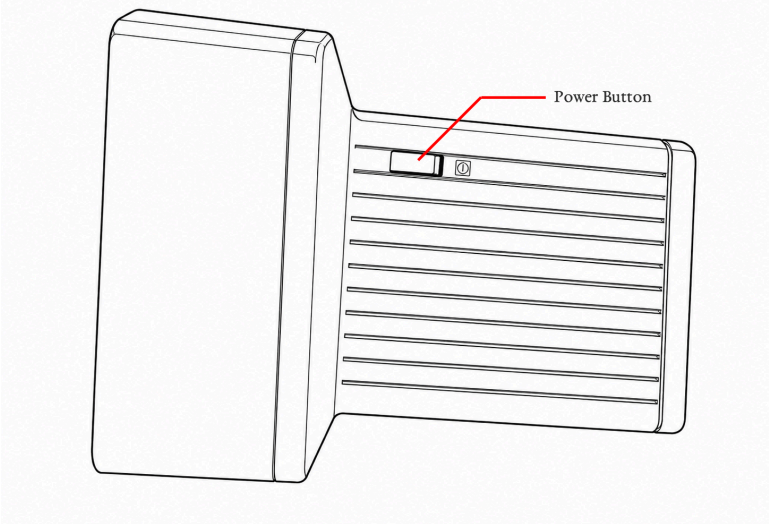


Figure 1-3e. The physical power button on the opposite side. This is separate from the Apple-logo touch control.

Taking a closer look

Before connecting anything, find the power control on the right side, the green status light at the front, and the chime-selector dial at the back. The Apple logo at the front is also a touch control. It is separate from the physical power switch.

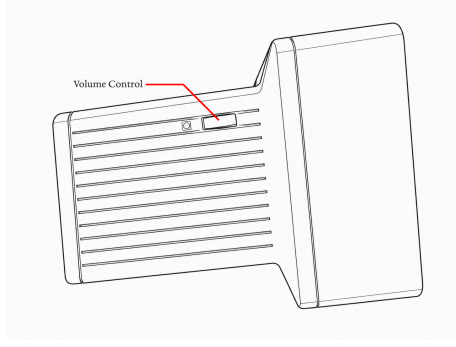


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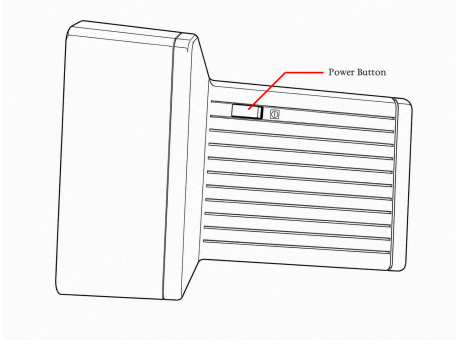


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Figure 3-1. View → Show Desktop returns you to the launcher without quitting the open applications.

Working with application windows

Several programs can be open at once. Click a window to bring it forward and direct your typing to it. Before typing a command or entering text, check that the intended window is active. An overlapping window is still open even when you can see only an edge of it.

Where a normal window has a title bar, drag it to a more useful position. Where a resize border or corner is provided, drag that border or corner to change the window's size. Some programs fix their window size or use the whole screen; those controls will not always be present.

Use a program's Quit or Exit command to leave it. A window close control closes that window, which may leave other windows from the same program running. A save question gives you a chance to keep changes; Cancel returns you to the work so you can decide.

Showing the desktop hides windows from view without saving or quitting them. Return to an open window by clicking its visible part or the appropriate Control Strip pane. Give the strip a moment to detect a newly opened program. Returning to a running program is different from deliberately opening another copy of it.

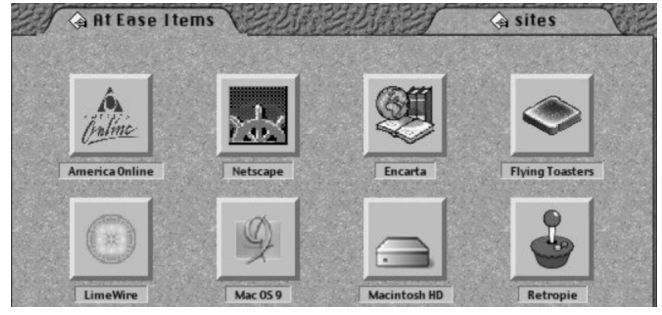
Window controls

The themed document window in Figure 3-2 has a close control at the upper left. At the upper right, the far-right control maximizes the window; the control immediately to its left minimizes it to the Dock, or Control Strip. Minimizing puts the window out of the way while leaving it open. Use the program's Control Strip pane to return to it.

Opening programs with AtEase

AtEase

Click an AtEase folder tab to choose a collection, then click a program button once. Allow time for the program to open. A launcher button starts a program; it is not the document you may later create inside it.



Show Desktop

If application windows cover the launcher, choose View → Show Desktop from PiForma Panel. This reveals the desktop without quitting the programs. You can then select another AtEase button. If the launcher is absent rather than covered, see Appendix B.



Appendix A: Technical Information

This appendix summarizes the inspected project records. It is not a wiring plan or a certification. Compare identifying labels and the running configuration before using it as a current-device specification.

Hardware inventory and identification

Donor:	Apple IIc Monitor A2M4090, recorded February 1985.
Computer:	Raspberry Pi 4 Model B, recorded 4 GB RAM.
Storage:	recorded 256 GB microSD.
Display:	recorded 9-inch LCD kit, working mode 800 × 480.
Main battery:	recorded Anker Prime 26K 300W.
Internal charger:	recorded 100W USB-C adapter.
Keyboard:	recorded Apple A9M0330 ADB keyboard, BLE conversion, ZMK, USB-C charging, nice!view.
Mouse:	recorded Bambu kit electronics in a printed shell, USB receiver.
Startup sound:	recorded YS-M3, CK1028 selector, separate salvaged speaker.
Normal sound:	recorded internal USB speaker.

Recorded power architecture

Recorded path: rear AC inlet → internal charger → main battery → original power switch → custom 5V JST rail → Pi, LCD controller, startup-chime module, and touch sensor. The USB speaker is supplied through the Pi. The switch does not disconnect the AC charging path. The rail has no separate installed fuse protection in the records.

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